

Adam Nguyen

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EDUCATION

University of Maryland, College Park

Aug 2026 – May 2028 (Expected)

M.S. in Computer Science — Incoming

College Park, MD

Virginia Tech

Aug 2022 – May 2026

B.S. in Computer Science GPA: 3.91 / 4.00

Blacksburg, VA

- **Coursework:** Theoretical Statistics, Probability, Advanced Calculus, Data Analytics, Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Data Structures & Algorithms, Computer Organization I & II, Computer Systems, Intro AI
- **Awards:** Barry Goldwater Scholarship Nominee (2025), Raytheon Fellowship (1 of 20 selected), Tyson Family Foundation Scholarship

PUBLICATIONS

Myeongseob Ko, Nikhil Reddy Billa, **Adam Nguyen**, Charles Fleming, Ming Jin, Ruoxi Jia. “Retracing the Past: LLMs Emit Training Data When They Get Lost.” **EMNLP 2025, Main Conference.**

Yi Zeng, Mahavir Dabas, Tran Huynh, Nikhil Reddy, **Adam Nguyen**, Sanchit Kabra, Ruoxi Jia. “Data is All You Need (Almost): Iterative Synthetic Instruction Tuning for Secure Code Generation.” 1st Proceedings of Amazon Nova AI Challenge (Trusted AI 2025).

MANUSCRIPTS

Feiyang Kang, Hanze Li, **Adam Nguyen**, et al. “Can Generalist Agents Automate Data Curation?” arXiv preprint, 2026.

EXPERIENCE

Undergraduate Researcher — Responsible Data Science Lab (ReDS Lab)

Oct 2023 – Present

Advisor: Prof. Ruoxi Jia, Virginia Tech

Blacksburg, VA

- Contributed across 6 ML and LLM research projects (3 resulting in papers), spanning HPC training infrastructure, agentic data curation, data valuation, and LLM memorization and safety.
- **LLM agents:** co-author on a Data Curation Agent that cleans, joins, and classifies multi-sourced datasets via automated Python pipelines with integrity checks built into the workflow.
- **Evaluation design + model behavior:** designed evaluation over 25+ holdout segments using benchmark suites, LLM-as-judge scoring, perplexity and similarity metrics, and ablations, with an automated harness for regression detection; contributor to EMNLP 2025 paper on LLM training-data emission.

Team Research Engineer — Amazon Nova AI Challenge (HokieTokie Team) Nov 2024 – June 2025

Collaboration with Amazon AGI Science; Ruoxi Jia (VT PI)

Seattle, WA

- **Ship fast:** built an AWS Bedrock deployment pipeline that cut model deployment from 2 hours to 15 minutes (8×); cut evaluation runtime from 2 hours to 20 minutes (6×) via concurrency and async.
- Managed AWS cloud infrastructure across an 8-month competition on a \$150K/month research budget; designed shared-drive architecture that increased team throughput 5×.
- Built and managed the environment scheduling SFT and DPO fine-tuning runs for an internal 7B model on H100 (p5) instances; supported vLLM inference deployment with Docker and Kubernetes.

Software Engineering Intern — Raytheon Technologies

May 2024 – Aug 2024

VT & Raytheon Fellowship (1 of 20 selected)

Richardson, TX

- Built Ansible and Bash automation to back up 10+ production servers in an enterprise environment; presented to a Raytheon Vice President in a 5-minute technical demo.
- Worked on a 10-developer agile team with daily standups, sprint planning, and code review.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

LLM Systems & ML: agent workflows, evaluation design (LLM-as-judge, regression), retrieval (BM25, embeddings), prompt design, SFT, pretraining; PyTorch, scikit-learn, HuggingFace, Weights & Biases

Data & Statistics: Python (pandas, numpy), SQL/PostgreSQL, ETL pipelines; probability, theoretical statistics, ablation studies, clustering

Systems & Tools: AWS (Bedrock, EC2, S3), Ray on Slurm, H100/GPU, Linux, Docker, Git, Jupyter; Claude Code, Codex